ENG-0010: Incident Postmortem for INC-019

Impact

The incident involving the auth-pipeline system (SYS-005) resulted in a temporary disruption of authentication services, classified as Severity 2 (Sev2). The system's medium criticality meant that while the impact was significant enough to warrant immediate attention, it did not cause widespread outage or critical failure of core business functions. The disruption lasted for approximately 5.5 hours, during which users experienced authentication failures, potentially affecting operational workflows within Project Zephyr. The incident was reported by Brian Ramirez, Procurement Specialist, and addressed promptly to restore normal service.

Timeline

- **2025-04-07**: The incident was reported by Brian Ramirez, Procurement Specialist, indicating authentication issues with the auth-pipeline system.
- **Immediately following report**: On-call engineer Daniel Kennedy was engaged to investigate the issue.
- **Resolution**: The root cause was identified as a configuration change applied to the auth-pipeline system, which was subsequently reverted or corrected.
- **Total resolution time**: 5.5 hours from initial report to full service restoration.

Throughout this period, communication was maintained between the on-call engineer Daniel Kennedy and relevant stakeholders to ensure timely updates and resolution.

Root Cause

The root cause of the incident was categorized under a "config_change." A recent configuration change within the auth-pipeline system (SYS-005) led to the authentication failure. The change was likely implemented without sufficient validation or review, resulting in unintended disruption of the system's functionality. This configuration change was the direct trigger for the Sev2 incident, highlighting the importance of rigorous change management procedures.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Description
Review recent configuration changes to auth-pipeline	Project Zephyr Lead (E-035)	ASAP	Conduct a thorough review of recent config changes to identify potential gaps in the change management process.
Implement stricter change approval protocols	Project Zephyr Change Management Team	Within 2 weeks	Enforce additional validation steps before applying configuration changes to critical systems like auth-pipeline.
	DevOps Team		

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Description
Enhance monitoring and alerting for auth-pipeline		Within 1 month	Improve monitoring tools to detect anomalies post-configuration changes promptly.
Conduct post-incident review and training	All relevant teams	Within 2 weeks	Ensure team members are aware of best practices and lessons learned from this incident to prevent recurrence.
Document and communicate lessons learned	Project Zephyr Leadership	Ongoing	Share insights from the incident to foster a culture of continuous improvement.

Additional Notes

The incident underscored the importance of meticulous change management and validation procedures, especially for systems integral to authentication processes. Daniel Kennedy, the on-call engineer, responded swiftly to mitigate the impact, demonstrating effective incident response coordination. Moving forward, Project Zephyr will reinforce its protocols to prevent similar configuration-related incidents, ensuring sustained system reliability for the auth-pipeline system.

This document is intended for internal use only and should be distributed among relevant teams involved in system management and incident response.